KSHEERA SAGARA MADHANAM - SCENE 01: THE PRIDE OF AMARAVATI

Sequence from "Krishna & Rukmini — The Abduction of Destiny"

Screenplay Draft #1

October 2026

FADE IN:

1 EXT. AMARAVATI - CELESTIAL PROMENADE - DAY 1

The sky is a radiant expanse of molten amber and spun silk. Floating crystalline spires pierce the upper stratosphere, connected by arches of solid rainbow.

Thousands of DEVA COURTIERS and APSARAS line the golden highway, cheering. Petals of Parijata flowers rain through the warm air, turning to sparkling embers before touching the flawless marble flagstones.

ATOP A COLOSSAL ELEPHANT—

AIRAVATA. Four ivory tusks curving toward the sun. A mountain of muscle draped in golden armor and silk brocade.

SEATED IN THE JEWELED HOWDAH—

INDRA (30s in immortal appearance). Radiance pouring from every pore. Clad in diamond breastplate and emerald-crested crown. His fingers casually roll a gold cup of Soma wine. His eyes are heavy with boredom and absolute supremacy.

AT THE ELEPHANT'S FLANK—

MATALI, the celestial charioteer, walks beside the tusker, holding the reins of Indra's battle car.

INDRA
(calling down, smirking)
Matali! Tell me—in all the records of the sages, has any king ever held a realm so peaceful, so entirely devoid of threat?

MATALI
(bowing slightly, measured)
None, My Lord. The Asuras remain broken in the subterranean dark. The mortals offer their daily oblations without question.

Indra takes a leisurely sip of wine, looking out over the limitless expanse of his celestial capital.

INDRA
Peace is not given, Matali. It is seized. The universe recognizes strength. We are the gods because we conquered.

Indra casually raises his right hand. Between his knuckles, a sharp crack of BLUE LIGHTNING flickers—the VAJRA. He points it playfully toward a distant white cloud.

CRACK!

The lightning strikes the cloud. A shower of iridescent pearls cascades onto the laughing courtiers below. They scramble to gather the gems, chanting Indra's name in ecstatic worship.

Indra laughs—a sound devoid of reverence. Pure ego.

INDRA (CONT'D)
Time is a wheel, they say. But they forget: the wheel turns beneath the feet of my elephant!

Matali looks ahead down the avenue. His eyes narrow. His posture stiffens.

MATALI
My Lord... look.

Indra doesn't look down. He refills his goblet.

INDRA
What is it? Another Gandharva seeking a boon?

MATALI
No, My Lord. A wanderer.

Through the shimmering heat-haze at the end of the promenade, a solitary, dust-covered silhouette walks against the festive tide.

MATCH CUT TO:

2 EXT. BHOJAKATA - PALACE COURTYARD - DAY (DWAPARA YUGA) 2

CLOSE ON: A sneering pair of eyes.

PRINCE RUKMI (20s), armored in black iron and gold, stands high upon the stone ramparts of his garrison fortress, looking down with the exact same haughty arrogance at his drilling phalanxes.

RUKMI
(to his lieutenants)
Let the Yadava cowherds hide behind their sea walls in Dwarka! Vidarbha bows to no upstart! My sister
(MORE)

RUKMI (CONT'D)
belongs to Chedi, and Chedi commands forty thousand chariots!

FADE OUT.